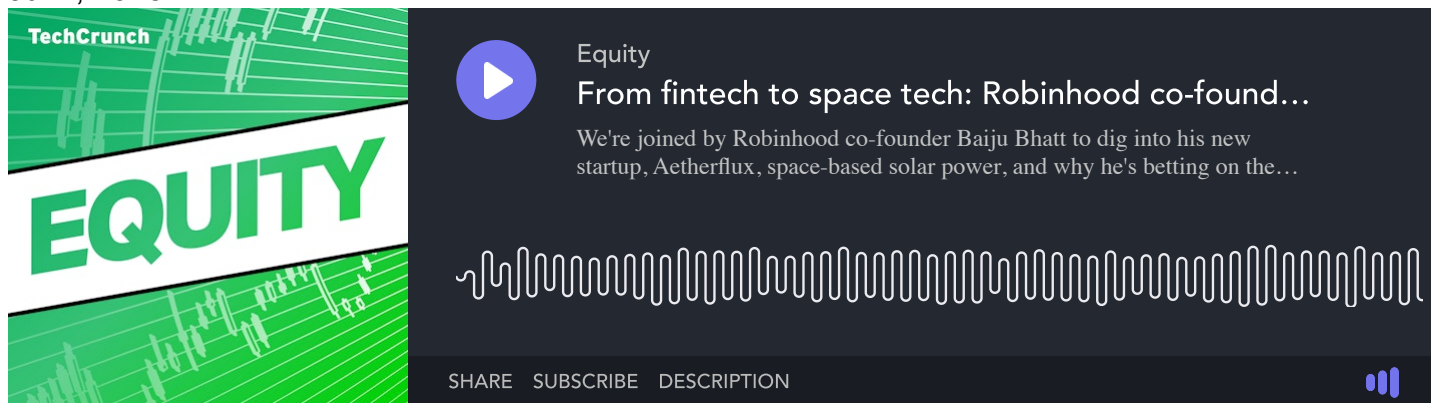


Robinhood's co-founder is beaming up (and down) the future of energy

Jul 2, 2025



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Robinhood's Baiju Bhatt has a new mission: solar power from space.

Fresh off a [\\$50 million Series A](#) raise, Robinhood co-founder Baiju Bhatt is going all-in on space-based solar power. His new startup, [Aetherflux](#), wants to launch solar power-collecting satellites into low Earth orbit, with a demo flight set for 2026, and to transmit clean energy back down to Earth.

Bhatt sat down with Rebecca Bellan on TechCrunch's [Equity](#) podcast to talk about his jump from fintech to frontier tech, what it takes to build a deep tech company from the ground up, and where investor interest in the space economy stands in 2025.

Listen to the full episode to hear more about:

- Why Bhatt thinks now is the time for space-based solar
- How Aetherflux is thinking about fundraising and scaling
- And Bellan and Bhatt's idea for a Burning Man light show (yes, really)

Bhatt also joined us on stage at [StrictlyVC Menlo Park last month](#) — and if you missed it, don't worry. StrictlyVC is coming to Palo Alto; you can join the waitlist [here](#).

Equity will be back tomorrow with a special rundown ahead of the long weekend here in the U.S., so stay tuned!

Equity is TechCrunch's flagship podcast, produced by Theresa Loconsolo, and posts every Wednesday and Friday.

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